Back to the case

A work for generations

Johann Friedrich Albrecht wrote about almost everything that moved his time. His letters, works and notes are now in different collections. Many texts are hardly read anymore; without careful development their connections remain invisible.

An academic association wants to make this scattered work accessible as a historical-critical complete edition. The participants know that they will not complete the project alone. Other people will have to understand, examine and continue their decisions.

A publisher takes over the elaborate book volumes. A later open digital provision is agreed, their objects and conditions have to be clearly distinguished. At the same time index, comments and cross references grow with each volume. What was initially manageable becomes a network.

This is why the edition also preserves its common working knowledge. A well-kept manual lays down rules, examples and responsibilities – so that a staff change does not force a new start every time.

> How do we get scientific connection without blocking necessary change?

Projects
: Works, letters and estates of a fictional scholar

Time horizon
: Decades and several project generations

Operation
: Federated groups with independent band editors

Publication
: Publishing volumes and time-differentiated digital approvals

Close-up
: Coordination, common data and long-term responsibility

Common rule knowledge is maintained, released and passed on.